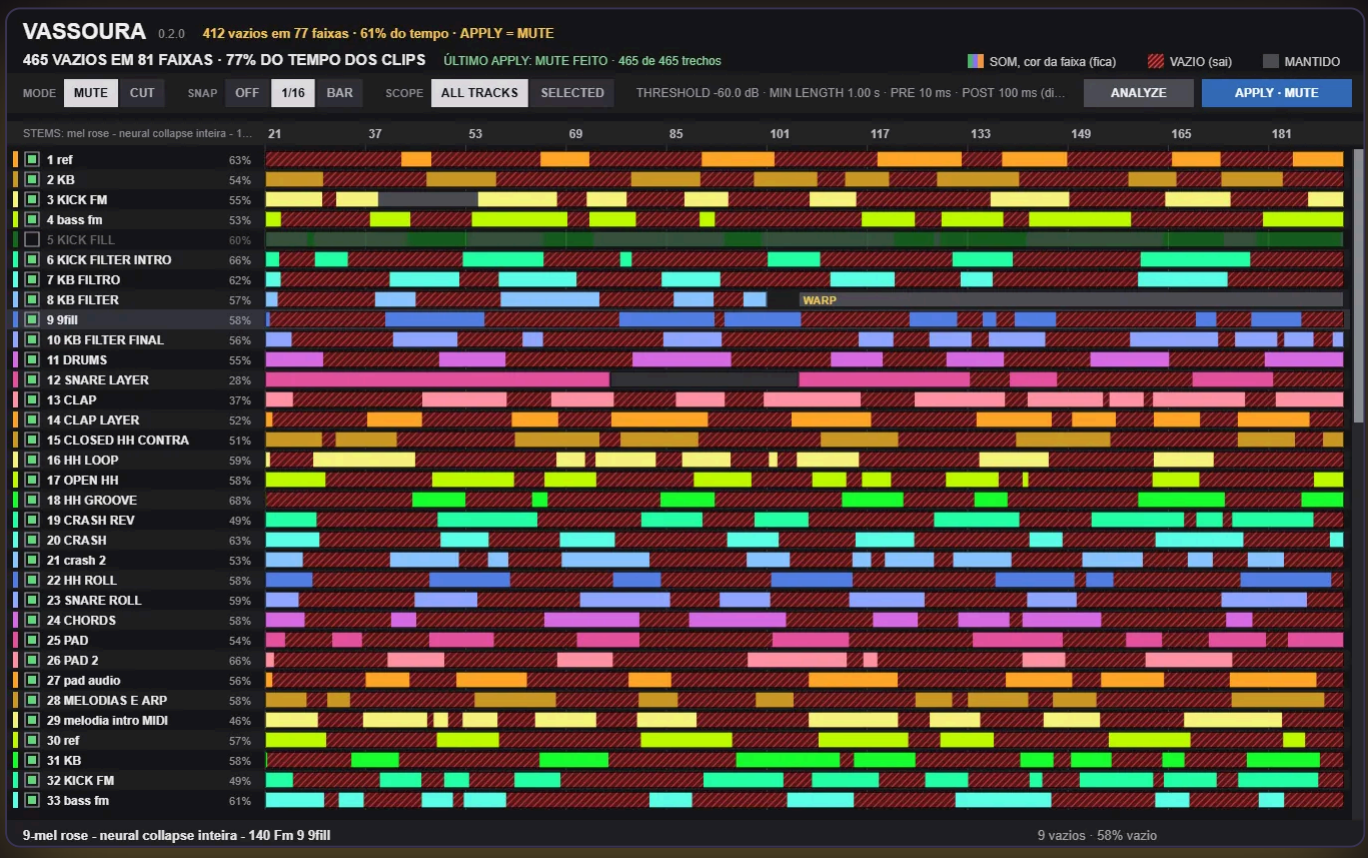
INSIDE STUDIO SP · MAX FOR LIVE

VASSOURA

SWEEPS THE SILENCE OUT OF YOUR STEMS

Step-by-step manual

Version 0.2.3 · Ableton Live 12 · Max for Live · free



insidestudiosp.com.br/vassoura · contato@insidestudiosp.com.br

What is VASSOURA

Mix and mastering stems usually arrive with the clip running **from the start to the end of the song**, even through the parts with no sound. VASSOURA reads every track in the set, finds these **empty stretches** in the arrangement's audio clips and:

- **MUTE**: splits the clip and deactivates the empty pieces (nothing is deleted); or
- **CUT**: deletes the empty pieces.

PRE and POST protect the attack and tail of every sound, and SNAP aligns the cuts to the grid. On a set with 81 stems it found 465 empty stretches in seconds.

It's not a VST: a regular plugin only receives audio and can't see the clips. VASSOURA is a **Max for Live Audio Effect**, which reads and edits the clips through Live itself.

Before you start

ITEM	DETAILS
Requirement	Ableton Live 12 with Max for Live (Live Suite, or Standard with Max for Live). Windows or Mac.
Price	Free. No activation needed.
Clips	Audio clips in the **Arrangement**, with **WARP off**. Clips with WARP on or in LOOP are left out (shown in gray).

Installation

1. Download the zip from **insidestudiosp.com.br/vassoura** and unzip it.
2. Copy the **whole folder** (Vassoura-<version>) to:
   `Documents\Ableton\User Library\Presets\Audio Effects\Max Audio Effect\`
3. The 3 files (**Vassoura.amxd**, **vassoura.js** and **vassoura_view.js**) **must stay together** in the same folder.

> **BEFORE THE FIRST APPLY, SAVE A COPY OF THE SET** (File › Save Live Set As…). Live doesn't let you group the edits into a single step: each muted or deleted stretch is a separate Ctrl+Z.

STEP 1

1 Put it on the first audio track

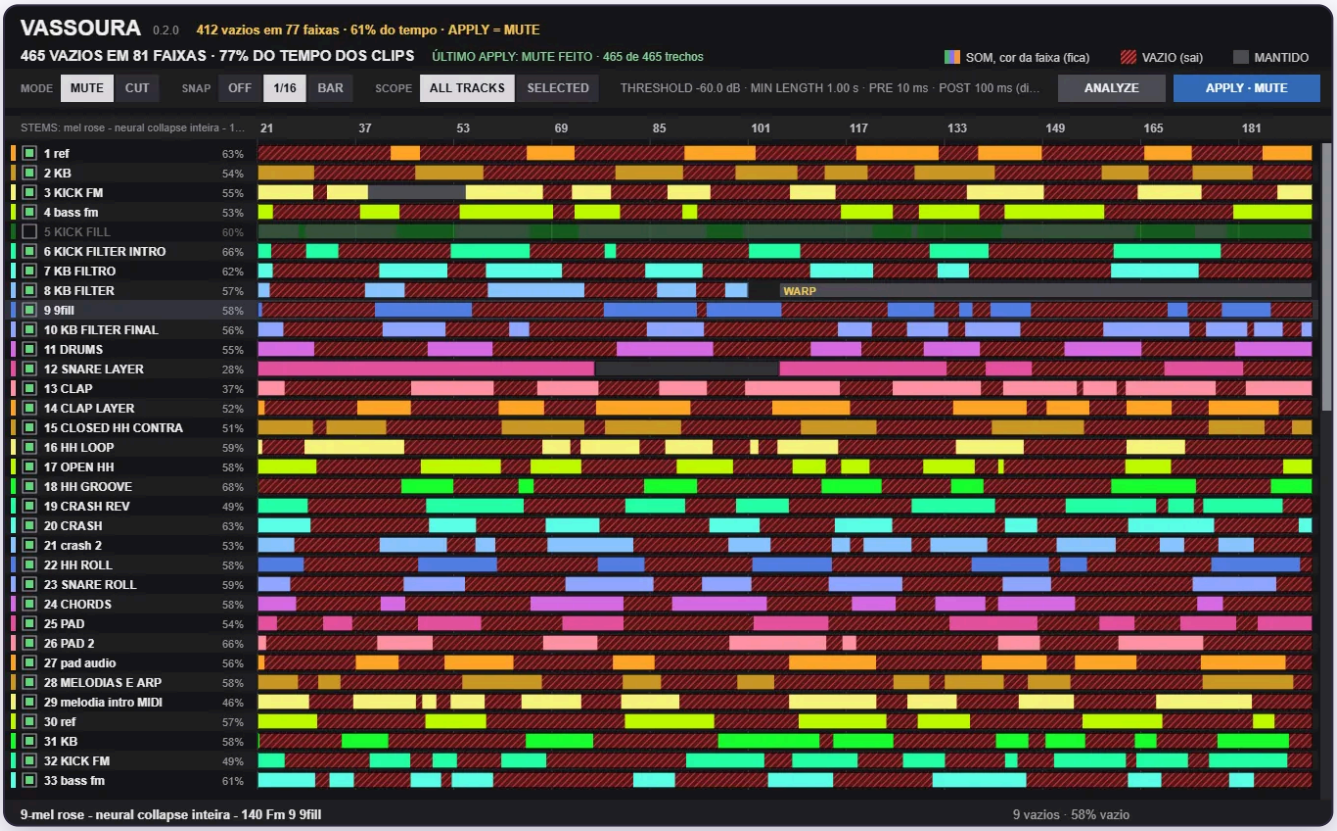
1. Open the set with the stems (audio clips in the Arrangement, WARP off).
2. Drag **Vassoura.amxd** onto the project's **first audio track**.

> **IT DOESN'T WORK ON THE MASTER:** from there ANALYZE can't read the clips. The audio of the track hosting the device passes through normally, in stereo.

STEP 2

2 ANALYZE and OPEN

1. Click `ANALYZE` (on the device or in the window). VASSOURA reads each clip's file, one track at a time.
2. Click `OPEN` to open the full window on top of Live.



The window: one row per track, with the bar ruler on top.

IN THE WINDOW	MEANING
Track color	Sound: stays.
Dashed dark red	Empty: removed on APPLY.
Gray	Kept (by you, by WARP/LOOP, or track excluded from cleanup).
Top	Summary: how many empty stretches, on how many tracks, and how much of the clip time is empty. After APPLY, the result of the last APPLY.
% right of the name	How much of that track is empty.

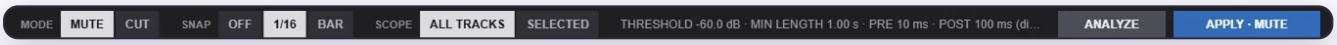
STEP 3

3 Define what counts as "empty"

The controls are on the device. The window **redraws instantly**, without re-reading the files.

CONTROL	RANGE · DEFAULT	WHAT IT DOES
THRESHOLD	−90 to −20 dB · **−60 dB**	Below this level is silence.
MIN LENGTH	100 ms to 10 s · **1000 ms**	Silence shorter than this stays (isn't treated as empty).
PRE	0 to 1000 ms · **10 ms**	Margin kept **before** each sound: the attack isn't cut.
POST	0 to 2000 ms · **100 ms**	Tail kept **after** each sound: reverb and release aren't cut.
SNAP	OFF / 1/16 / BAR · **OFF**	Cuts land on the grid, always inside the silence.
SCOPE	ALL / SELECTED · **ALL**	All tracks, or only the selected track (click ANALYZE again).
MODE	MUTE / CUT · **MUTE**	MUTE deactivates the empty pieces; CUT deletes them.

MODE, SNAP and SCOPE can also be changed by clicking the window's bar.



Window bar: MODE, SNAP, SCOPE, the current values, ANALYZE and APPLY.

> **TIP.** Stems with long fades or reverb? Raise POST.

STEP 4

4 Choose what stays

- **Click a red stretch** to **keep** it (it turns gray).
- **Click the track name** to **exclude it from cleanup**.

STEP 5

5 APPLY

1. Make sure you **saved a copy of the set**.
2. Click `APPLY`. In **CUT**, it asks for a **second click within 4 s** to confirm.
3. When it's done, VASSOURA re-reads the set and the window shows the result.

How APPLY edits

- For each clip, a **working copy** is placed after the end of the song, trimmed to the length of the empty stretch, **checked** and pasted over it. Live splits the original clip around it. In CUT, the piece is deleted.
- If the copy doesn't match the empty stretch's length **exactly**, that stretch is **skipped** (the set isn't touched there).
- At the end, the working copy is deleted. If a clip is left over at the end of the arrangement, delete it by hand.

Limitations

- Clips with **WARP** on and clips in **LOOP** show in gray and aren't touched.
- **FADE:** Live doesn't let a device change clip fades. To avoid clicks at the cuts, keep *Preferences › Record, Warp & Launch › "Create Fades on Clip Edges"* on (it's on by default).
- A frozen track (**Freeze**) can't be edited: it's skipped and reported in the Max console.
- Each edited stretch is a separate **Ctrl+Z**.

FAQ and troubleshooting

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
"v8: can't find vassoura.js"	The 3 files aren't in the same folder as the .amxd. Copy the whole folder again. Another fix: open the device in the Max editor, click **FREEZE** (snowflake) and save.
ANALYZE finds nothing	Is the device on the master? Put it on the first audio track. Also check that the clips are in the Arrangement with WARP off.
A whole track shows in gray	Clip with WARP on, in LOOP, frozen track, or a track you excluded from cleanup (click its name).
It cut the attack or the tail	Undo (Ctrl+Z or go back to the set copy) and raise PRE or POST before applying again.
Too many small empty stretches	Raise MIN LENGTH.
Clicks (pops) at the cuts	Turn on "Create Fades on Clip Edges" in Live's preferences.
A clip is left after the end of the song	It's the working copy: delete it by hand.
An error occurred or Live closed	Open the Max console (on the device: edit › Max › Window › Max Console). The "VASSOURA:" lines show each clip and each skipped stretch. Every ANALYZE writes the file **VASSOURA-log.txt** in the device folder: the last line shows where it stopped. Send the screenshot or the file to support.

30-second summary

1. **Save a copy of the set.**
2. VASSOURA on the **first audio track** (not the master).
3. **ANALYZE** → **OPEN**.
4. Adjust THRESHOLD, MIN LENGTH, PRE, POST and SNAP while watching the window.
5. Click what you want to keep; choose **MUTE** or **CUT**.
6. **APPLY** (in CUT, click twice).

SUPPORT. Questions, suggestions or issues: **contato@insidestudiosp.com.br** · **insidestudiosp.com.br**